IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 30, 2026

Capex Verdict

Hyperscaler capex sticker shock punishes three of four Mag7 prints after a historic four-dissent FOMC hold; NXPI surges 25.55% on physical-AI guidance, QCOM gains 4.00% with after-hours follow-through, and Brent rallies 6.85% as the Hormuz blockade hardens.

S&P 500	NASDAQ COMP	NXPI	BRENT (BNO)	FEAR & GREED
~7,116 ↓0.02%	+0.61% · XLK ↑0.80%	$289.25 ↑25.55%	$58.81 ↑6.85%	29 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

HYPERSCALER CAPEX VERDICT — THREE OF FOUR MAG7 SELL OFF AFTER HOURS, ONLY GOOGL CLEARED THE BAR

The S&P 500 finished essentially flat at roughly 7,116 (−0.02%) and the Nasdaq Composite added 0.61% as XLK gained 0.80%, but the headline tape became secondary to the after-close print sequence. Microsoft beat at $4.27 EPS on $82.89B revenue with Azure constant-currency growth guided to 39%-40% and AI now running at a $37B annualized rate, yet shares fell roughly 3% after-hours per Bloomberg as Microsoft signaled FY26 capex of approximately $190B. Meta beat the top and bottom lines and dropped roughly 6%-7% post-close per Benzinga after lifting 2026 capex guidance from $115B-$135B to $125B-$145B, citing higher component pricing. Amazon delivered AWS at $37.59B (+28% year-over-year, the fastest growth in 15 quarters per CNBC) and EPS of $2.78 versus $1.63 expected, but slipped roughly 3% after-hours on $44.2B Q1 capex and a roughly $200B FY26 spending stance per Seeking Alpha. Alphabet was the singular winner: Q1 revenue $109.9B, Cloud +63% to $20B with a $460B backlog per Fortune, and FY26 capex raised to $180B-$190B; shares rallied roughly 7% after-hours per CNBC. The dispersion is itself the signal — the market is now demanding capex translate to demonstrable revenue acceleration, and only one of the four delivered.

NXPI SURGES 25.55% ON PHYSICAL-AI STRENGTH — THE LARGEST SINGLE-DAY GAIN SINCE THE 2010 IPO PER CNBC

NXPI closed Wednesday at $289.25 (+25.55%) following Tuesday's after-close beat — CNBC characterized the move as the biggest single-day gain since NXP's 2010 IPO. EPS came in at $3.05 against $2.98 consensus on revenue of $3.18B, with Q2 guidance of $3.35B-$3.55B at the lower end above the $3.27B Street estimate per company materials and Investing.com coverage. Management commentary highlighted broad-based strength across automotive, Industrial & IoT, mobile and communications, with explicit callouts on software-defined vehicles and physical AI at the edge. Truist Securities raised its price target to $310 from $255 citing the AI and data center exposure, with Morgan Stanley, Needham, TD Cowen and Raymond James all lifting targets per published research. The print is the cleanest validation of IOWN's "physical world matters" thesis on this earnings cycle and carries direct read-across to ADI (+1.58% Tuesday), TEL (+0.47%) and the broader analog complex.

QCOM GAINS 4.00% ON THE DAY, ADDS MORE AFTER HOURS ON HYPERSCALER DATACENTER CHIP WIN — THE MOST CONSEQUENTIAL IOWN PRINT OF THE WEEK

QCOM closed Wednesday at $156.00 (+4.00%) after reporting fiscal Q2 revenue of $10.6B and non-GAAP EPS of $2.65, at the high end of guidance, with QCT revenue at $9.1B and licensing at $1.4B per company commentary and Bloomberg coverage. Automotive revenue exceeded $5B annualized for the first time, with management guiding to a $6B-plus exit run rate by fiscal year-end. The market response extended into the after-hours session on CEO Cristiano Amon's commentary that QCOM will begin shipping data center chips to a large hyperscaler ahead of schedule and that the China smartphone cycle has likely bottomed; CNBC reported the stock rallied as much as 16% in late trading. The print materially extends the AI-edge optionality runway and adds a hyperscaler datacenter revenue stream that was not in any sell-side base case. Carson's SPY $645.80 support remains active and untested, well below current trading.

FOMC HOLDS AT 3.50%-3.75% — FOUR DISSENTS MARK THE MOST DIVIDED VOTE SINCE OCTOBER 1992 IN POWELL'S FINAL PRESS CONFERENCE

The Federal Reserve held the target range steady at 3.50%-3.75% in an 8-4 vote per CNBC and Fox Business reporting, with three of the four dissenters explicitly seeking removal of the easing bias from the statement — the most fractured FOMC vote since October 1992. Chair Powell delivered what he framed as his last press conference as chair, with his term expiring May 15, and stated he intends to remain on the Board of Governors until the Federal Reserve investigation reaches transparency and finality. The dissent count and the hawkish tilt of the dissenters together push the path of least resistance on policy toward higher-for-longer, and TLT closed Wednesday at $85.70 (−0.78%) as the long end repriced. The Powell-to-Warsh succession ahead of the May 15 transition now has the structural backdrop of an unusually divided committee, an inheritance an incoming chair will have to either consolidate or cede.

S&P 500	~7,116 · ↓0.02% · Flat into Mag7 stack
MSFT / META / AMZN AH	~−3% · ~−6% · ~−3% · Capex sticker shock
GOOGL AH	~+7% · Cloud +63% · $460B backlog
NXPI / QCOM / GD	+25.55% · +4.00% · +7.99%
FOMC	3.50–3.75% hold · 8–4 vote · Most dissent since Oct 1992
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY $645.80 support · Untested · Set Apr 13

When three of four hyperscalers beat the print and three of four sell off the after-hours, the market has communicated that capex without revenue acceleration is no longer enough — and that one name has cleared the bar redefines the AI-tape leadership cohort. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

TRUMP HARDENS THE HORMUZ BLOCKADE — BRENT SURGES 6.85% AS IRANIAN STORAGE REPORTEDLY APPROACHES CAPACITY

President Trump publicly committed Wednesday to maintaining the US naval blockade against Iran until Tehran agrees to a comprehensive nuclear framework, per CNBC and CBS News reporting from Day 61 of the conflict. Brent crude surged about 6% to settle at $118.03 per barrel and WTI advanced nearly 7% to $106.88 per barrel per CNBC, with the IOWN data drop showing BNO closing up 6.85% to $58.81 and USO up 7.90% to $150.63. Al Jazeera and Kpler analysis indicated Iranian onshore crude storage could reach capacity within 12 to 22 days if the blockade persists, raising the prospect of forced production curtailment that would further tighten an already constrained physical market. Strait of Hormuz transits remain at roughly 5% of normal volumes per IBTimes coverage, and the IEA continues to characterize the disruption as the largest energy supply shock on record. The diplomatic structure has hardened: Iran's Hormuz-first proposal received a public rejection, the Kushner-Witkoff Pakistan trip was cancelled, and the administration's posture is now an explicit linkage of the blockade to nuclear concessions.

IOWN ENERGY SLEEVE CAPTURES THE HORMUZ TAPE — VLO +4.59%, CVX +2.05%, CTRA +3.03% AS THE SECTOR LEADS

Energy was the clear sector leader Wednesday with XLE at +2.29%, and IOWN's integrated-energy and refining exposure participated cleanly. VLO advanced 4.59% to $251.30 as refining margins continued to widen against the supply shock; CVX added 2.05% to $192.22; CTRA gained 3.03% to $35.68 ahead of today's print; and CNX edged up 0.38% to $39.32 with its own report due. OKE softened 0.52% in a give-back from Tuesday's post-earnings move. The Morgan Stanley framing that refining margins are unlikely to return to pre-conflict levels in the near term remains the structural underpinning of the VLO position. Gold compressed 1.07% and silver fell 2.05% as risk capital continued the unusual rotation toward equity and energy rather than precious metals at this stage of a geopolitical shock — a pattern more consistent with stagflation positioning than with classical risk-off behavior. Five IOWN names report today, two of them in this energy sleeve: CTRA (consensus $0.86) and VLO (consensus $3.18).

TRUMP POSTURE	Blockade until nuclear deal · Day 61 of conflict
BRENT / WTI	BNO ↑6.85% · USO ↑7.90% · Brent ~$118
IRAN STORAGE	12–22 days to capacity · Per Kpler / Al Jazeera
ENERGY LEADERS	VLO ↑4.59% · CVX ↑2.05% · CTRA ↑3.03%
GOLD / SILVER	GLD ↓1.07% · SLV ↓2.05%
HORMUZ TRANSITS	~5% of normal · Per IBTimes

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Q1 advance GDP and March Personal Income & Outlays both print at 8:30 AM ET — the PCE component is the single most consequential data release of the week. Per the IOWN data drop, consensus pegs Q1 GDP advance growth at 2.3% quarter-over-quarter annualized (versus 0.5% prior), Core PCE QoQ at 4.1%, headline PCE Price Index YoY at 3.5% (versus 2.8% prior), and Core PCE YoY at 3.2% (versus 3.0% prior). The headline PCE MoM consensus of 0.7% versus the 0.4% prior is the read most likely to move the long end. The Atlanta Fed GDPNow nowcast sat at 1.2% as of April 29 per its release schedule, well below the 2.3% Street consensus — a wide gap that introduces material headline risk in either direction. With four FOMC dissenters now publicly seeking removal of the easing bias, an in-line or hot core PCE print would meaningfully harden the higher-for-longer rate path that TLT (–0.78% Wednesday to $85.70) is already starting to price. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

2. AAPL reports tonight after close — iPhone, Services and the Cook-to-Ternus transition framing. Consensus per Apple Insider and Yahoo Finance sits near $1.95 EPS on revenue of approximately $109.7B, with iPhone consensus near $56.5B and Services consensus near $30B. The qualitative Q3 commentary on the call has historically driven post-print moves more than the headline; this report is the first in which management will field questions on Tim Cook's September 1 transition to John Ternus per Mac Observer reporting. Options pricing implied a roughly 5.4% post-earnings move per Yahoo Finance, materially elevated versus the 1.9% four-quarter average. Apple is not an IOWN holding, but the print's read-across to TSM (+0.38% Wednesday to $393.83), the broader semiconductor sleeve, and the dollar tone going into Friday's month-end positioning carries direct portfolio relevance. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. Five IOWN names report today — CAT before bell is the read on industrial demand and energy backlog. CAT consensus sits at $4.66 per share per the IOWN data drop, with the Energy & Transportation segment carrying outsized weight given the data center power-generation backlog that has rerated the stock through April. CAT closed Wednesday at $810.05 (−0.96%). SYK (consensus $3.01) prints today as well, with the dispersion to watch being whether MedTech demand continues the strength flagged in J&J's Q1 commentary. CTRA (consensus $0.86), CNX (consensus $0.94) and VLO (consensus $3.18) round out the energy sleeve's reporting cadence — the read on Permian gathering volumes from CTRA and refining margins from VLO will inform whether the OKE-CVX-VLO chain extends. The post-NXPI semis sleeve carries fresh momentum into ADI (+1.58% Wednesday) and TEL (+0.47%), with CRDO (+5.94%) and AMD (+4.30%) participating in the recovery from Tuesday's compression. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. GD beat by $0.31 and ADP beat by $0.05 — the dividend sleeve carried the morning earnings cohort. GD reported $4.10 per share against $3.79 consensus and shares closed up 7.99% to $338.73, the cleanest defense-sleeve win against the backdrop of the Trump $1.5T defense plan that had drawn rare Republican pushback per prior reporting. Operating earnings rose 12% year-over-year to $1.42B with a 10.5% margin per company materials, and Electric Boat's 29% increase in Columbia program earned hours flagged in the release supports the multi-year backlog conversion thesis. ADP beat at $3.37 versus $3.33 consensus and rallied 7.98% to $215.06, with the print carrying read-across to the labor backdrop as Friday's payroll data approaches. The combination of NXPI, QCOM, GD and ADP delivers four of the strongest IOWN earnings reactions of the cycle in a single 24-hour window. *Avoid Erosion.*

5. The digital-asset sleeve absorbed a 13% HOOD drop and a 6% COIN drop — structural-flow thesis under pressure. HOOD closed Wednesday at $71.20 (−13.24%) on the post-earnings reaction to a 47% year-over-year decline in crypto trading revenue, with revenue and EPS missing consensus per CoinDesk and Yahoo Finance coverage. COIN dropped 6.37% to $181.73 in sympathy. IBIT eased 1.20% to $42.75 and ETHA fell 2.99% to $16.85 as bitcoin traded near $76,300 per Latestly — below the broader recent range. Robinhood's prediction-markets revenue surged 320% year-over-year to $147M per CoinDesk, partially offsetting the crypto compression and validating the diversification of the platform model. The HUT, MARA, and CRDO crossover thesis with AI-power infrastructure remains intact — CRDO rallied 5.94% Wednesday in a notable reversal from Tuesday's 8% drawdown — while HUT fell 1.54% and MARA dropped 2.72% on the broader crypto compression. *The physical world matters.*

6. The VIX proxy advanced even as the cash tape held flat — positioning is hedging into the GDP/PCE print. UVXY closed up 3.74% Wednesday to $38.02, an unusual divergence with a flat S&P 500 and a positive Nasdaq close. The repricing reflects three concentrated near-term risks: this morning's GDP/PCE release with a hot 0.7% headline PCE MoM consensus, AAPL after close, and the month-end rebalance flow that historically introduces dislocation on the last trading day. Brent's 6.85% advance Wednesday extends the energy-inflation pass-through risk that the four FOMC dissenters explicitly flagged, and the combination is now visible in the rates complex with TLT at $85.70. The pair-trade between energy beneficiaries and rate-sensitive growth remains the principal portfolio cross-current; the NXPI breakout suggests the physical-AI cohort is becoming a third leg of leadership distinct from both the hyperscaler-capex story and the energy-supply-shock trade. **Think Like an Owner.**

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